

Friday, 15 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Drizzle

12° 8°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

13° 6°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

13° 7°

GLASGOW

Overcast

12° 5°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 How would a Labour leadership contest work?.

How could MPs who want to see Sir Keir Starmer replaced force a leadership contest?

POLITICS · UK

2 Watch: Best moments from the Bafta TV Awards.

Netflix drama Adolescence was the big winner at the Bafta Television Awards on Sunday, while The Celebrity Traitors also scooped a share of the glory.

UK · NEWS

3 Faisal Islam: Six things we now know about the UK economy in charts.

The UK economy is showing resilience – it's worth diving into the data in more detail to understand why.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1

What you need to know about the second Eurovision semi-final and grand final.

Eurovision 2026 is taking place in Vienna after Austrian singer JJ won the 2025 event.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

Behind the scenes on Rivals season two: 'It's bigger, bolder, bonkier!'

Stars including Danny Dyer, Aidan Turner and David Tennant share secrets on the set of the hit show.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

Eurovision boss: 'We're watching the voting very carefully'.

Martin Green says attempts to influence voters will be taken seriously, but stops short of sanctions.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Italian Open tennis match delayed by cup final fireworks.**
A match at the Italian Open is halted for almost 20 minutes by smoke from fireworks after the Coppa Italia final at the neighbouring Stadio Olimpico.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Assist of the season? Mesmerising Foden keeps title hopes alive.**
Phil Foden's magical first-half assist proves the catalyst that Manchester City needed to maintain their challenge in this season's fascinating Premier League title race.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Fifa risking player safety over heat at World Cup - scientists.**
A group of world-leading scientists warn Fifa its current heat safety measures for the men's 2026 World Cup are "inadequate" and could put players at risk of serious harm.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Controversial 99th-minute penalty boosts Celtic title hopes.**
Watch the penalty award against Motherwell that keeps Celtic's Scottish Premiership title hopes alive going into a final-day showdown with Hearts.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The most-Google'd DIY question in Britain this year: 'how to remove silicone'.**
Tradespeople say it's the rise of botched bathroom resealing jobs during lockdown that's still haunting people. YouTube tutorials on the topic have racked up 60 million views.
- 2 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.
- 3 Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.**
Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.
- 4 The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 5 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 6 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 7 62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.**
Most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to faking a whole dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 71% of us admit to doing **THIS** in the car when we think no-one is watching. What is it?
ANSWER: SINGING AT THE TOP OF OUR LUNGS, WITH FULL DRAMATIC FACIAL EXPRESSIONS.

Q Asked 'what's the most British thing about your morning?', the number one answer wasn't a cup of tea — it was **THIS**.
ANSWER: APOLOGISING TO SOMEONE WHO WALKED INTO YOU.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new study says we form a strong opinion of someone within 7 seconds of meeting them.**
Talk-back: what's the quickest you've ever decided you didn't like someone — and were you right? Or the quickest you DID like someone?
- **Matching pet-and-owner outfits are apparently making a comeback this summer.**
Would you actually do it? And if so — does the dog get a vote in the wardrobe?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **UK News.** A council in the North-West has agreed to fix a much-complained-about pothole only after a resident planted a small tree in it and the photo went viral. The pothole had been reported 17 times in a year before the tree solved it overnight.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Devon village has voted unanimously to ban Vinted couriers from parking on its narrow high street, after a single delivery driver knocked over the same pub's hanging basket three weeks in a row.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.04 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.04 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Sharks existed before trees. Sharks have been around for 400 million years; trees only 350 million.
- Bubble wrap was originally invented as wallpaper. It flopped, so they pivoted to packaging.
- There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on every beach on Earth.
- A group of flamingos is called a flamboyance.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896 — it lasted 38 minutes.
- Your stomach gets a new lining every three to four days. Otherwise it would digest itself.
- The first message ever sent on the internet was 'LO' — they were trying to type 'LOGIN' but the system crashed.
- An ostrich's eye is bigger than its brain.

On this day

Day 135 of the year, 230 days left in 2026. Today Aoi Matsuri (Kyoto); Army Day (Slovenia); Christian feast day: Achillius of Larissa; Christian feast day: Athanasius of Alexandria (Coptic Church). Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1979 — Daniel Caines, English sprinter
- 1989 — Susan Soonkyu Lee, Korean-American singer and entertainer
- 1988 — Scott Laird, English footballer
- 1942 — Lois Johnson, American singer-songwriter (died 2014)
- 1959 — Beverly Jo Scott, American-Belgian singer-songwriter
- 1940 — Lainie Kazan, American actress and singer
- 1960 — Rob Bowman, American director and producer
- 1953 — Mike Oldfield, English-Irish singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1963 — Project Mercury: The launch of the final Mercury mission, Mercury-Atlas 9 with astronaut Gordon Cooper on board. He becomes the first American to spend more than a day in space, and the last American to go into space alone.
- 2010 — Jessica Watson becomes the youngest person to sail, non-stop and unassisted around the world solo.
- 2001 — A CSX EMD SD40-2 8888 rolls out of a train yard in Walbridge, Ohio, with 47 freight cars, including some tank cars with flammable chemical, after its engineer fails to reboard it after setting a yard switch. It travels south driverless for 66 miles (106 km) until it was brough...

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2001 — A CSX EMD SD40-2 8888 rolls out of a train yard in Walbridge, Ohio, with 47 freight cars, including some tank cars with flammable chemical, after its engineer fails to reboard it after setting a yard switch. It travels south driverless for 66 miles (106 km) until it was brough...
- 1991 — Édith Cresson becomes France's first female Prime Minister.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2024 — Prime Minister of Slovakia Robert Fico is shot and critically injured while meeting with supporters at an event in Handlová.

- 1945 — World War II: The Battle of Poljana, the final skirmish in Europe is fought near Prevalje, Slovenia.
- 1988 — Soviet–Afghan War: After more than eight years of fighting, the Soviet Army begins to withdraw 115,000 troops from Afghanistan.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 136 of the year, 229 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Abda and Abdjesus, and companions: Abdas of Susa; Christian feast day: Andrew Bobola; Christian feast day: Brendan the Navigator (Roman Catholic Church, Anglican Communion, Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1964 — Milton Jones, English comedian, actor, and screenwriter
- 1955 — Debra Winger, American actress
- 1990 — Amanda Carreras, Gibraltarian tennis player
- 1937 — Yvonne Craig, American ballet dancer and actress (died 2015)
- 1948 — Judy Finnigan, English talk show host and author
- 1971 — Rachel Goswell, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1969 — David Boreanaz, American actor
- 1944 — Billy Cobham, Panamanian-American drummer, composer, and bandleader

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1943 — The Holocaust: The Warsaw Ghetto Uprising ends.
- 2014 — Twelve people are killed in two explosions in the Gikomba market area of Nairobi, Kenya.
- 1925 — The first modern performance of Claudio Monteverdi's opera *Il ritorno d'Ulisse in patria* occurred in Paris.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1974 — Josip Broz Tito is elected president for life of Yugoslavia.
- 1919 — A naval Curtiss NC-4 aircraft commanded by Albert Cushing Read leaves Trepassey, Newfoundland, for Lisbon via the Azores on the first transatlantic flight.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026

FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)

JUNE 2026

FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026

WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		